

MACHINE LEARNING

DEEP LEARNING: REGULARIZATION FOR NEURAL NETWORKS

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Parameter initialization

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- ▶ The **weights** and **biases** are usually initialized as **small random values** of a **normal or uniform distribution**.
- ▶ Larger starting weights help to **avoid losing signal** during forward and back-propagation.
- ▶ Too large weights, however, result in **exploding values** during forward propagation.

Regularization

- ▶ Typically, a deep neural network has **too many parameters** and will **overfit** the data at the global minimum of $J(\theta)$.
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Parameter penalties

- ▶ Similarly to **lasso** and **ridge regression**, we introduce an extra term in the objective function that **penalizes** the size of the parameters:

$$J_{\text{reg}}(\theta) = J(\theta) + \alpha\Omega(\theta),$$

where $\alpha > 0$ is a tuning parameter and $\Omega(\theta)$ is a norm penalty term, e.g.,

$$\Omega(\theta) = \sum_{i,j,m} w_{ij}^{(m)2},$$

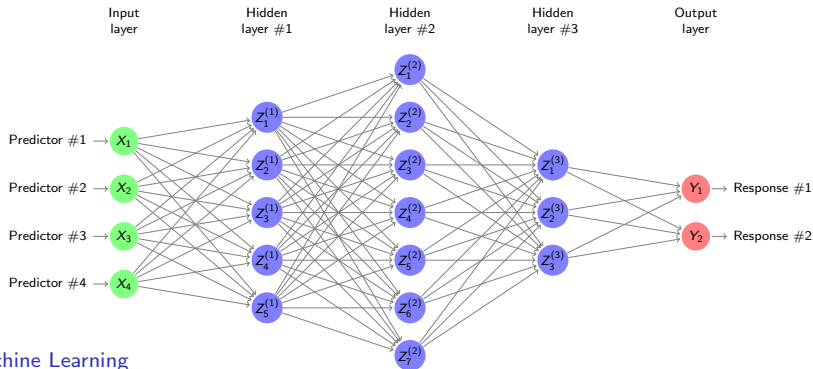
or some other norm such as ℓ_1 .

- ▶ The **interpretation** is similar as for regularized linear models, and the tuning parameter is also chosen by **cross-validation**.

Regularization

Dropout

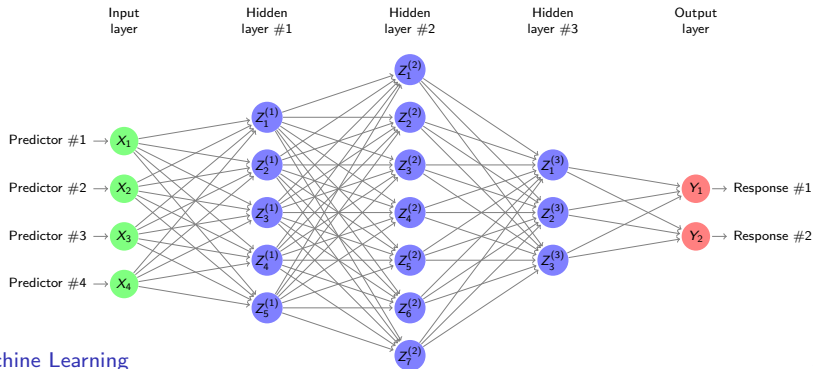
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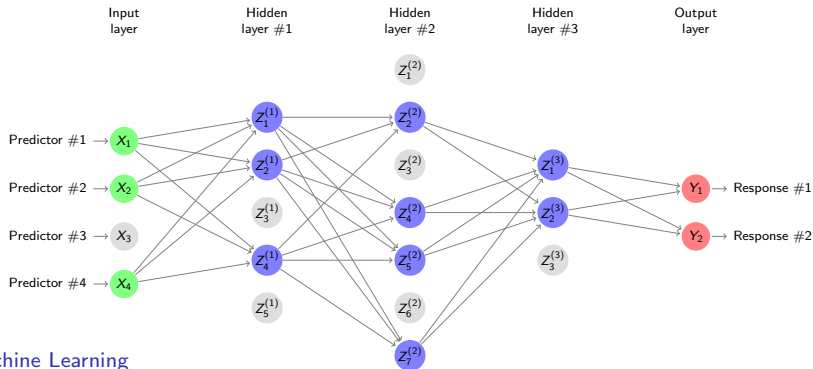
- ▶ **Dropout** is a regularization method where in each update step in the gradient descent, the **network structure** is changed.
- ▶ In fact, before a forward pass and back-propagation, each **non-output neuron** is **independently** dropped out with some probability $q \in [0, 1]$.
- ▶ For **hidden units** this probability is usually $q = 0.5$, and for **input units** $q = 0.2$.



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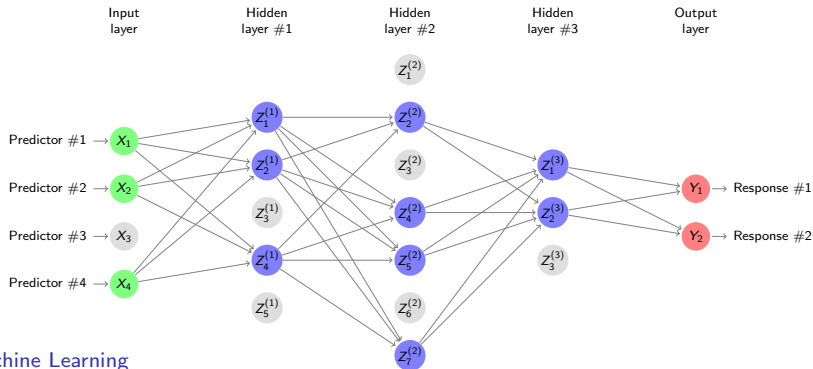
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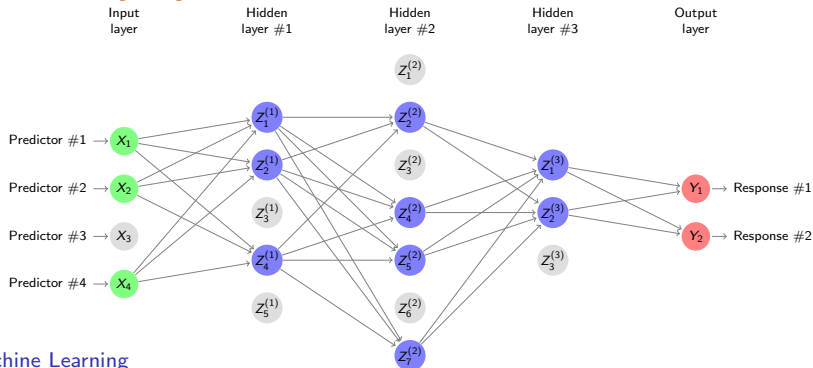
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- ▶ This **robustifies** the fitting, since every unit must learn to work independently from the dropped units.
- ▶ Dropout is a type of **bagging**, where the final model is a **combination** of the fitted weights and the **dropout probabilities**.



Regularization

Early stopping

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- ▶ For large networks with enough **capacity to overfit** the training error decreases steadily over time, but the **validation error** begins to raise at some point.

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Regularization for deep neural networks is an active **domain of research**; the whole Chapter 7 in the book *Deep Learning* by Goodfellow et al. (2016) is devoted to this topic.